

## TOPIC 5: THE STUDY OF COLOURS (PART 2)

### 1. Local Colours and Their Sources

Local colours are colours obtained from natural materials in the environment. Sources include: leaves, bark, roots and flowers for plant dyes; clay and earth for ochres and browns; charcoal for black; chalk or limestone for white. Traditional Nigerian crafts often use such local dyes and pigments.

### 2. Attributes / Characteristics of Colour

- **Hue** – the name of the colour (red, blue, green).
- **Value** – lightness or darkness.
- **Intensity (chroma)** – brightness or dullness.
- **Temperature** – warm (reds, oranges, yellows) or cool (blues, greens, purples).

### 3. Uses of Colour

Decoration, symbolism (e.g. white for purity, red for danger or vitality), identification, creating mood, directing attention, and cultural expression in festivals, clothing and crafts.

### 4. Summary

Local colours come from natural sources. Understanding hue, value, intensity and temperature helps artists use colour effectively for beauty and meaning.

End of Topic 5